

Working Effectively in Schools Unit 2

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Unit 2 - Overview

- Working Effectively with Teams
- Managing Conflict

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Qualities of a Strong Team Activity

Give one – Get one

1. Individually – Create a list of characteristics of a strong team
2. Walk around the room, share an idea and get an idea and add it to your list if it isn't already there
3. Repeat until we rejoin the main group

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10 Characteristics of Successful Teams

1. Clear Goals
2. Defined Roles
3. Open and Clear Communication
4. Effective Decision-Making
5. Balanced Participation
6. Valued Diversity
7. Managed Conflict
8. Positive Atmosphere
9. Cooperative Relationships
10. Participative Leadership

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Six Characteristics that Make a Highly Effective Team

1. Each team member has emotional intelligence
2. Good mix of introverts and extroverts
3. They share and understand common goals
4. They make time for humour
5. They communicate proactively
6. Strong leadership at the helm

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Difficult People



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What is Conflict?

- When you hear the word conflict, what comes to mind?
- Write down your definition of conflict.

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What is Conflict?

Discussion

Think about whether or not conflict is good or bad.
Think about examples of positive and negative conflicts you might encounter in your role as an Educational Assistant

Is it conflict when only one party is aware of the disagreement?

Does all conflict look as though one party's gain would be another's loss?

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Conflict

Brené Brown on Blame

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RZWf2_2L2v8

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Types of Conflict

1. Task Conflicts
2. Process Conflicts
3. Relationship Conflicts
4. Status Conflicts

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Types of Conflict

Task Conflicts

Task conflicts are **disagreements** about **what** work is to be done.

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Types of Conflict

Process Conflicts

Process conflicts are **disagreements** about **how** the work gets done.

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Types of Conflict

Relationship Conflicts

Relationship conflicts are **disagreements** between **who** is involved.

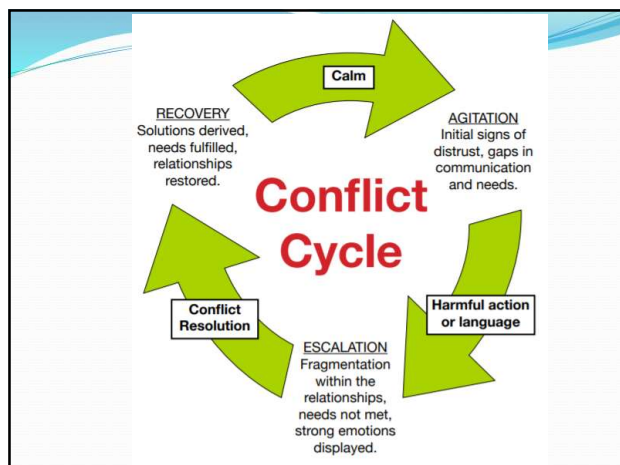
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Types of Conflict

Status Conflicts

Status conflicts are **disputes** over **who is where** within the social hierarchy of a group.

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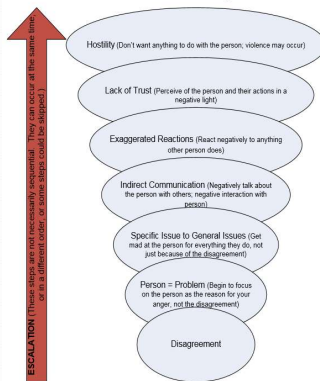
Conflict Cycle



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SfFibSYVChE>

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Conflict Spiral



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Self- Awareness

- Some conflicts elicit mild discomfort, while others produce severe emotional distress.
- Our level of comfort with specific conflicts depends on various factors including our personalities, our past experiences, our cultures, etc.
- Different people may have a different comfort level with the same conflict.

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Self- Awareness

Discussion

What are some conflicts that make you uncomfortable?

Identify what made you uncomfortable and describe your feelings.

How self-aware are you during heated situations? How often do you check in with yourself during these situations to see if you are being realistic and fair?

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

BEHAVIORS ARE VISIBLE, NEEDS ARE NOT

- People do not always tell us what they need. They behave. We must look behind the behavior to understand their needs. Most behaviors can be driven by different needs, so to name a behavior does not describe the unique needs driving it.
- What are some needs that if not met may trigger a conflict?

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

It is important to understand needs in order to skillfully resolve conflicts in ways that are satisfying to all the people involved. When "needs" are mentioned in relation to conflict resolution, we aren't talking about, "I need that new pair of shoes," or "I need sushi!" "Needs," also known as "underlying needs" or "basic human needs," refers to those things that allow us to survive and thrive as human beings. All human beings, regardless of where they are from, how they were raised, or what they believe in, have the same basic human needs. Human needs are requirements for survival and healthy physical, social, intellectual, and emotional development and contentment.

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

Examples of different needs are:

- Sustenance (basic physical needs for food, air, water, shelter, physical health)
- Safety (physical safety, emotional safety)
- Love (affection, support, appreciation)
- Understanding (empathy, learning, respect)

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

- Creativity (self-expression, work, contribution)
- Community (belonging, connection, acceptance)
- Rest/Recreation/Play (sleep, joy, renewal)
- Autonomy (self-governance, choice, freedom)
- Meaning (purpose, beliefs, faith, hope)

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

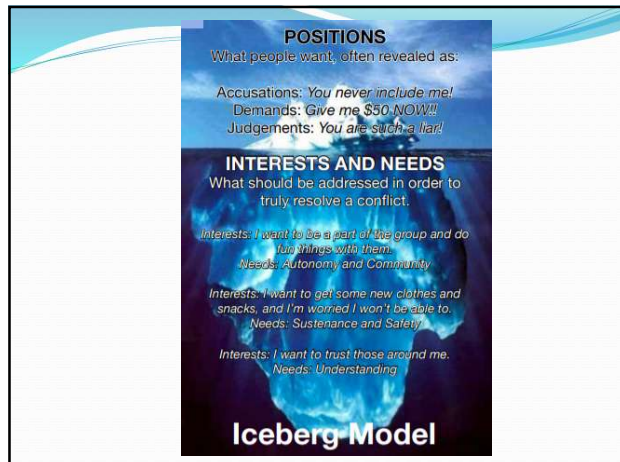
- The basis of all conflict is when underlying needs are not met.
- As we are trying to satisfy our needs, we take specific actions to meet them. These actions are called strategies.
- Positions are often presented as demands, accusations, and judgments, and the positions held by the people involved in a conflict are often at odds with one another.

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Underlying Needs: The Cause and Solution for Conflicts

- Focusing on interests and needs rather than positions help people come up with creative strategies for resolving conflict!

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The Iceberg of Conflict

Positions

For every position there is an opposition. This is the place where conflict lives.

Assumptions

Check your assumptions. If you start checking your assumptions, you might find you had it all wrong, or that you misread the intentions. Misreading intentions is a common source of conflict.

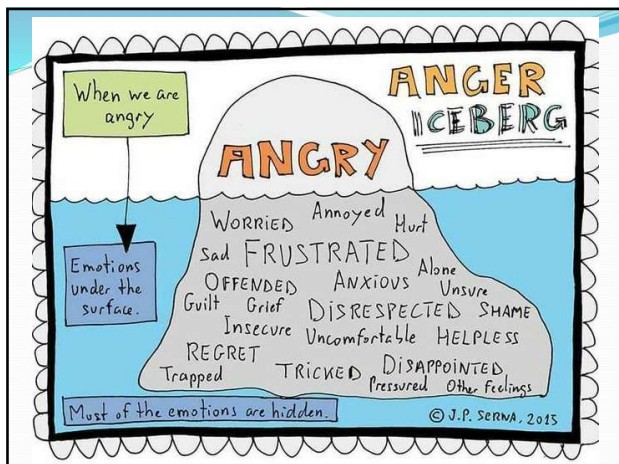
Aspirations

Find the common ground at the aspiration level.

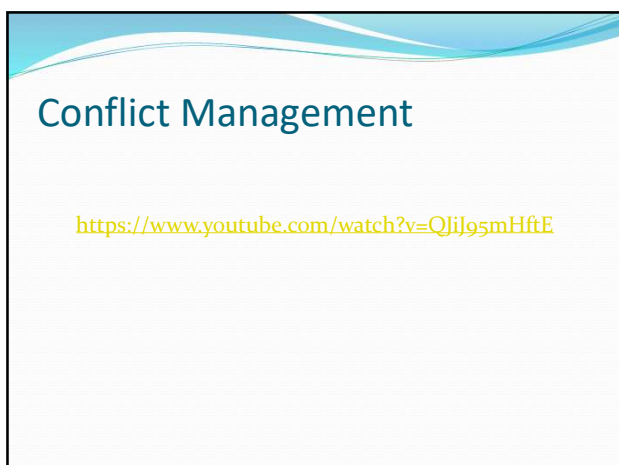
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Conflict Management Styles Assessment

1. Complete 13 Handout Conflict Management Styles Assessment – circle the one response that best describes you (page 1) – there are no right or wrong answers
2. Tally your score (page 2) the style with the highest score indicates your most commonly used strategy.
3. Refer to page 3 for a description of the five Conflict Management Styles

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Modified Thomas Kilmann Conflict Questionnaire



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Modified Thomas Kilmann Conflict Questionnaire

1. Complete 14 Handout Modified Thomas Kilmann Conflict Questionnaire
2. Read the statements and circle 1, 2, or 3 depending on what is most like you.
3. Write down the number you circled next to its corresponding letter (bottom of page)
4. Total each column

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Modified Thomas Kilmann Conflict Questionnaire

Column I “No Way” Those with the highest number in column I have a tendency to **Avoid** when in a conflict: These types prefer not to deal with the problem at hand, and/or they don’t feel the issues in dispute or the relationships involved are important.

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Thomas Kilmann Questionnaire

Column II “Your Way” Those with the highest number in II have a tendency to **Accommodate**, and/or give in (it can be perceived as losing): These types prefer to “give in” rather than to get confrontational about anything. This approach can also be used by people who care about the relationships with the persons involved in the situation, but don’t really care about the issue.

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Thomas Kilmann Questionnaire

Column III “My Way” Those with the highest number in III have a tendency to **Control/Compete/ Persist** (it can be perceived as winning): These types see everything as a challenge that they want to dominate. In some situations, it may be a good idea to use this approach (i.e., when your basic rights are being violated) but, in some instances, it may be damaging.

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Thomas Kilmann Questionnaire

Column IV “Half Way” Those with the highest number in IV have a tendency to **Compromise**: If the issue and relationship are important and you have limited time or resources, this may be the best approach (your friend really wants to hang out all day, but you have to study, so you stop by for only a short time after you study).

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Thomas Kilmann Questionnaire

Column V “Our Way” Those with the highest number in V have a tendency to **Collaborate**: These types prefer to derive creative strategies to resolve conflicts because they would like to preserve the relationships and achieve their goals as well. This approach usually leads to win-win

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Thomas Kilmann Grid – 5 Styles

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O4eObpGH3lo>

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Conflict Management Styles Assessment

1. In what situations is your management style helpful and when is it a hindrance?
2. What conflict management style will you need to work on within the context of your role as Educational Assistant?

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Choosing the Right Conflict Resolution Method

- Even though you may prefer one of the conflict resolution strategies over the others, all these strategies can be used effectively in certain situations.
- For example, if the issue is minor and won't have lasting consequences, it may be in your best interest to accommodate the other party rather than to try to serve your own needs. However, if the issue is more severe and will impact multiple people, it may make sense to choose a strategy with more assertiveness.

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Choosing the Right Conflict Resolution Method

To choose the best conflict resolution method in any given situation, you need to consider several factors, such as:

- How important your desires are.
- The impact on you or others if your desires are not served.
- The consequences of choosing to be more assertive.
- Whether a collaborative or cooperative solution exists.

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Underlying Needs Worksheet

Think of a conflict that you currently face at school, with a friend, sibling, etc.
Ask yourself the following questions:

1. What are the sources of the conflict?
2. What are the positions of the people in the conflict?
Your position(s):

The other side's position(s):
3. What are the underlying interests and needs of the people in the conflict?
Your interests and needs:

The other side's interests and needs:
4. What are some strategies that can help you and the other side meet the above interests and needs?
5. (Optional) Share your responses with your partner and discuss other possibilities for positively resolving the situation.

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Assertive Communication

- Assertive communication is defined as *"The ability to speak and interact in a manner that considers and respects the rights and opinions of others while also standing up for your rights, needs, and personal boundaries"* (Pipas & Jaradat, 2010, p. 649).
- Assertiveness is an effective and nonconfrontational way of expressing one's disagreement with a particular situation or concept.

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Assertive vs. Aggressive Communication

Assertive Behaviour	Aggressive Behaviour
Promotes equality	Denies the rights of others
Is respectful	Is demeaning or hurtful
Speech is firm but gentle	Speech is loud or menacing
Is in control	Is out of control
Communicates confidence	Communicates haughtiness
Uses a relaxed stance	Uses a rigid stance
Personal space is respected	Personal space is violated

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Assertive vs. Aggressive Communication

Assertive Behaviour

The impact is calm
Behavior is supportive
Is honest and forthright
Facial expression is relaxed
Involves requests
Goal is to express needs
Is respectful of rules
Results in problem-solving

Aggressive Behaviour

The impact is agitated or emotional
Behavior is competitive
Is deceitful or manipulative
Facial expression is tense
Involves demands
Goal is to win
Does not value rules
Creates more problems

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I-Messages

Use the formula:

I think _____ (your thoughts about the situation).

I feel _____ (be sure to state an emotion rather than a thought. For example: excited, frustrated, concerned, etc.).

because _____ (provide the specific reason you are feeling this way, preferably with an example).

I want _____ (provide a suggestion on what you think could resolve the situation).

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I-Messages

Example – Unequal distribution of chores: **I think** that the housework is divided unequally. **I feel** overwhelmed and frustrated **because** I spend so much of my time doing housework after working all day. **I want** to talk about how the housework is divided and find a better way to distribute the chores.

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I-Messages

Example – Distractions during family mealtime: **I think** dinner time is an important time to spend as a family. **I feel** frustrated and concerned that some of our family text friends or watch videos during meals **because** I think dinner time is a good opportunity to talk to each other. **I want** to have all electronics turned off during dinner so we can reconnect with each other.

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Improving Your Ability to Resolve Conflict

Being able to choose and apply the best conflict resolution strategy effectively is made possible by developing better conflict resolution skills.

Examples of conflict resolution skills that can help you include the ability to:

- Listen effectively.
- Identify specific points of disagreement.
- Express your own needs clearly.
- View conflict as an opportunity for growth.
- Focus on specific issues without generalizing or escalating the situation.

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Listening Tips

Ask Open-ended questions:

- What happened?
 - How did this situation affect you?
 - What concerns you?
 - What kind of solution works for you?
 - How can this relationship be fixed?
 - What would you like to see happen?
- VERSUS**
- Did he annoy you?
 - Do you feel upset?
 - Are you concerned?
 - Would it work for you to meet up once a week?
 - Do you want to be friends again?
 - Would you like her to apologize?

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Listening Tips

How Questions:

- "How can we solve this conflict with one another?"

VERSUS Why Questions:

- "Why aren't you able to get along?"

Body Language

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Listening Tips

Active listening:

Encouraging:

- "Tell me more about why you think your teacher doesn't like you."

Clarifying:

- "How is your friend being hard on you?"

Restating:

- "So you're upset that she borrowed your pencil and then chewed on it."

Reflecting:

- "You seem to be sad that you're not spending as much time together."

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Listening Tips

Summarizing:

- "You thought the sensory room was going to be available but the reading group was using the room. Then you didn't have a quiet space to practice the calm down routine. Is that correct?"

Validating:

- "Thanks for being willing to share how this conflict is affecting you."

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Steps of Conflict Resolution

Step 1

Create a positive environment

Step 2

Clarify the issue

Step 3

Explore interests and create understanding

Step 4

Reach a workable solution

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Observations vs Judgements

- Observations are what we can see with a camera and hear with an audio recorder, without involving perceptions or assumptions. Observations describe what you actually see and hear. They do not evaluate.
- Judgments evaluate, and are when we start to put perceptions, assumptions and biases into the mix. They often involve a right vs. wrong dynamic. (right vs. wrong way to do things, blame/counter-blame, offense/defense, etc.)

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Communicating without Judgement

1. Making requests not demands
2. Silence
3. "We" and "I" rather than "You" language
4. Focus on the problem, not the person
5. Neutralizing
6. Reframing
7. Reality check
8. Suggest Solutions
9. Remain open to ideas

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Analogy: Cars in an Alley



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What is Your Relationship with Conflict?

Conflict is a place of possibility | Dana Caspersen | TEDxHackneyWomen

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WfQeH3o9zSc>

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What is Your Relationship with Conflict?

- Are you an avoider or seeker?
- Is all conflict negative or bad?
- Are you able to listen past the attack and hear what is important?
- What can you say to avoid attack?
- Are you able to remain curious in difficult situations where emotions are high?
- Do you see possibility in every conflict?

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Cats and Costumes



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The Power of Apology - Discussion

- When and why would you offer an apology?
- What makes an apology sincere?
- What makes a bad apology?
- What is the correct way to apologize?
- How do you feel about being forced to make an apology?
- Do you think it is useful to *make* students/coworkers apologize then the have done something *wrong*?

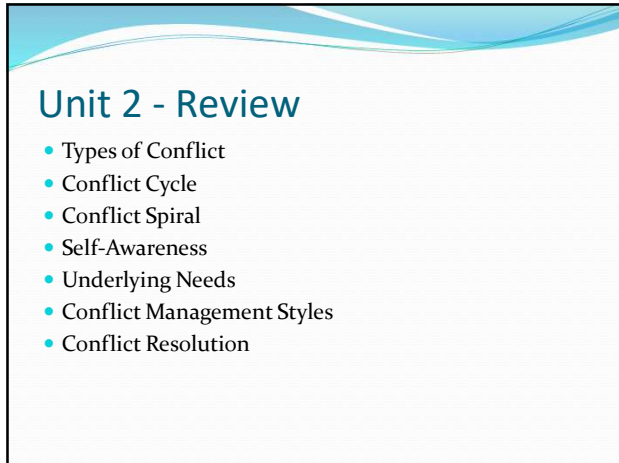
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Conflict

Discussion

- How has your thinking about conflict changed?
- What strategies could you use if you are faced with a conflict?

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Unit 2 - Review

- Types of Conflict
- Conflict Cycle
- Conflict Spiral
- Self-Awareness
- Underlying Needs
- Conflict Management Styles
- Conflict Resolution

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